

THE PAYSON MORNING SCROLL

MADE EXCLUSIVELY FOR THE MOGOLLON'S HEARTH GUESTS

"All the news worth knowing before the mead hall opens."

THE GREYBEARDS OF HIGH HROTHGAR — PUBLISHER & PROPRIETOR

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Henny holds court on the sun-warmed deck, daring a single cloud to show itself.

SKIES O'ER THE HOLD

80° / 54°

Sunny

Sunrise 6:20 AM · Sunset 6:07 PM

Tomorrow — Sunny, 82/56

OVERHEARD LAST NIGHT

A trapper swears the quitting horn had a second voice humming underneath it — deep as a bear in a barrel. The barkeep only shrugged: "That's Jethro, practicing his harmonies for fair week."

AROUND THE HOLDS · THE WEEK AHEAD

North Inch Faire Opens; Bulls Ride at Dusk



Payson, Ariz.



Opening day beneath the Rim: caber-tossing, axe-throwing and archery on the fairways, while a Nord rider faces the bulls by torchlight.

HAIL and well met, friends of the Hearth, on a golden Fredas morning! Frostfall deepens — the lowlanders call it "October", a clanking great name for a month of

pine smoke and honeyed light — and the Hold fairly hums with it: this very day the North Inch Renaissance Faire throws wide its gates, a whole Scottish village ris-

en upon the Payson Golf Course fairways, while at the Event Center the 72nd Annual Northern Gila County Fair rides into its second day with bulls at dusk. Bagpipes by morning, bulls by evening — by the Nine, Rim Country has outdone itself. Below: what's on today in every Hold, the days ahead, the Hearth's own quests, a mead-hall of the Verde Valley, and word from the wider Rim.

HAPPENING IN THE HOLDS TODAY

• Payson

— **North Inch Renaissance Faire** — opening day, 9 AM–5 PM, Payson Golf Course, 1504 W Country Club Dr. The inaugural Scottish village wakes: artisans, combat demonstrations, Highland games, axe throwing and archery, the Queen of Scots' court, and a lone Scots piper whose queer wind-device wails like a heartbroken mammoth. \$8 adults, \$4 children; active-duty military free.

— **72nd Annual Northern Gila County Fair** — day two at the Payson Event Center, 1400 S Beeline Hwy; gates 9 AM, livestock shows and the Arizona State Fiddle Festival all day, and pro bull riding at 6 PM. Fair admission \$3–\$5.

• Sedona

— **First Friday in the Galleries** — monthly gallery receptions 4–7 PM along Gallery Row, 336 AZ-179. Meet the artists, music, wine tastings, and treats among the red rocks.

• Show Low

— **30th Annual Dave Conatser XC Invite** — high-school cross-country invitational, 9–11 AM at McHood Park.

— **The Locals Market** — weekly local market 3–7 PM at the Pinedale Public Library in Pinedale. Vendors, Gosling Ranch goods, and often a food truck.

• Prescott

— **Prescott Area Artist Studio Tour** — opens today; a free self-guided tour of 74 artists across 52 private studios plus three art centers, 10 AM–4 PM daily through Sunday. Watch live demonstrations, meet the artists, and buy original work.

— **Bees Fall Classic Car Auction** — preview day from 3 PM at Pine Ridge Marketplace, 3106 Gateway Blvd; the live auction kicks off Saturday at 11 AM. Free admission and parking.

— **Doug Dillman Live** — live music on Whiskey Row, 7–10:30 PM at the Whiskey River Tavern, 214 S Montezuma St.



Main Street, Payson — the Hold's own high street.

THE DAYS AHEAD

• Loredas, 3rd of Frostfall (Sat, Oct. 3)

— **North Inch Renaissance Faire** — the faire's long day, 9 AM–9 PM on the Payson Golf Course

fairways, 1504 W Country Club Dr. A full day of Scottish artisans, combat demonstrations, music, and storytelling in the inaugural Highland village — the one day to stay for the evening merriment. \$8 adults, \$4 children; active-duty military free.

— **Northern Gila County Fair** — final day at the Payson Event Center, 1400 S Beeline Hwy; gates 9 AM and the 72nd annual fair wraps tonight about 10 PM. Pro bull riding, ranch rodeo, goat roping, the Junior Livestock Auction, and the Arizona State Champion Fiddle Festival. Admission \$3–\$5.

— **Pine-Strawberry October Craft Fair** — the 36th annual fall craft fair, 8 AM–5 PM at the Pine-Strawberry Community Center Ramada, 3886 N Highway 87, Pine. Handmade goods from Rim Country crafters on smoke-free, alcohol-free grounds; continues Sunday 8 AM–4 PM.

— **Verde Valley Farmers Market** — the final market of the 2026 season, 8–11 AM at 75 E Hollamon St, Camp Verde. The last chance this year for Verde Valley produce and local goods before the stalls close for the season.



The folk festival: fiddles, reels, and dancing on the grass.

— **42nd Folk Music Festival** — Sharlot Hall Museum, Prescott; gates 9 AM, music 10 AM–5 PM across the museum grounds. Local and regional acoustic musicians and dancers celebrate Prescott's folk heritage, a tradition since 1980. \$15 for non-members; members and children under 9 free.

• **Sundas, 4th of Frostfall (Sun, Oct. 4)**

— **North Inch Renaissance Faire** — final day, 9 AM–5 PM at the Payson Golf Course. The last chance to walk the inaugural Highland village before the tents come down. \$8 adults, \$4 children; active-duty military free.

— **Sedona Community Farmers Market** — 8–11 AM at 2201 W SR 89A, Sedona. Local growers and makers in the red rocks; go early for the best pickings.

• **Tirdas, 6th of Frostfall (Tue, Oct. 6)**

— **Trail Day Volunteer Build** — 7 AM–noon off Highway 87 just before Pine (parking at the large circular dirt turnout). Pine-Strawberry Fuel Reduction volunteers clear brush, move rocks, and shape trails that double as fire-access routes; bring water, sunscreen, and gloves, tools provided. Email trails@psfuelreduction.org to join.

A SPECIAL SPREAD

North Inch Renaissance Faire



The Queen of Scots holds court on opening day.

This very morning, the gates swing wide on something Payson has never seen: an inaugural Scottish renaissance faire, a whole Highland village risen upon the fairways of the Payson Golf Course.

Within the palisade: artisans at their crafts, combat demonstrations, Highland games, axe throwing and archery, music and storytelling, the Queen of Scots' court in session — and one lone Scots piper, whose queer wind-device wails like a heartbroken mammoth. (The crowd, mind you, dresses Nord; the Scotsmen are but a traveling few.)

The shape of the weekend: today is opening day, 9 AM–5 PM; Loredas is the long day, 9 AM–9 PM, with evening merriment; Sundas closes the

village, 9 AM–5 PM. Three days, then the tents come down.

Payson Golf Course, 1504 W Country Club Dr · Today 9 AM–5 PM; Sat 9 AM–9 PM; Sun 9 AM–5 PM · \$8 adults, \$4 children; active-duty military free · northinchrf.com

Why go: The one weekend all year the Hold turns Scottish — an inaugural Highland village on the fairways, and Loredas's long day runs into the evening merriment.

QUESTS OF THE HEARTH

Quests awaiting:

- ☐ **Print the torch sconces** — Due Loredas, Oct. 3 — print two torches plus the socket test piece; test-fit the bulb and socket first.
- ☐ **Design & prep the torch sconces** — Overdue since Sept. 26 — measure the flame bulb and socket, then find or design the wall-torch sconce model.

The sconce printing must fire by Loredas, and the design sits overdue — the Hearth's torchlight waits on thee.



The craftsman's bench, where the Hearth's torch sconces take shape — and the shield waits its turn.

MERCHANT OF THE HOLD

Verde Brewing Company · Camp Verde



The brewhouse at Verde Brewing Company, where the taps never run dry.

Verde Brewing Company is an independent craft brewery and gastropub tucked into an industrial park off the beaten track in Camp Verde, pouring twelve of its own brews — no magic required, just malt, hops, and patience. The signature pour is the Wildflower Honey IPA, brewed with local wildflower honey, alongside the Smokey Rye Lager and the Gold Buckle honey lager. The kitchen keeps a family-friendly American menu built for beer — the thing to order is the elote nachos with pulled pork, heaped crisp flatbread the reviewers rave about.

“We stopped here on our way back to Phoenix from Sedona. The brewery is a little off the beaten track but easily found. The staff were friendly and the beer was excellent. I really enjoyed the sour. Also the food was very good especially the hotdogs. Recommend a visit.” — a [TripAdvisor review](#)

724 N Industrial Dr, Unit 7a, Camp Verde, AZ 86322 — open daily 11 AM–9 PM; (928) 300-6724; \$\$ moderate; the beer garden is dog-friendly, and happy hour runs Mon–Fri 2–5 PM (\$2 off pints). · [their scrying-mirror page \(other travelers call it a ‘website’\)](#)

Why the Hearth sends you: A true mead-hall of the Verde Valley — Camp Verde’s own independent brewery, where Valley Dwellers can taste the valley in a glass and carry a growler home to the Hearth.

STORIES AROUND THE RIM

GONE UP THE HILL TO THE BARROW



The barrow on the hill, where the ravens rose all at once.

Word reached the Hold on Fredas last, carried by a trader come down through Pine with his mules and his marvels — and by the Nine, it was worth the hearing.

The hooded stranger has been seen. Well — nearly. Two days past, say the Riverwood folk (a lumber village of the lowlanders, north past the tall pines), a traveler in a dark hood bought out the trader’s whole stock of iron arrows, paid with a septim bitten clean in half, and asked the way to the old barrow on the hill.

Then the accounts go sideways, as accounts do. The innkeep swears he ate three sweet rolls and left the crumbs in a perfect circle. The blacksmith’s boy says he calmed a spooked mule with a single word — a WORD, mind you — and every raven on the hill took flight at once. Mabel doesn’t believe a word of it.

By the time our rider reached Riverwood, the stranger was gone up the hill. Ten minutes, the trader says. Ten minutes!

(Earl, for the record, is still not speaking to Gus.)

TALES FROM THE TREELINE

HENNY'S SHINY BROOD



*Henny claims Flurry's bottle-cap hoard as her own
— the lost-and-found is closed until further notice.*

On a sun-warmed Fredas morning, with the whole Hold smelling of pine and possibility, Henny (the Hearth's plump Skyrim-style chicken) discovered Flurry's hollow log.

Flurry (a young ice-breathing dragon) keeps his life's treasure there: bottle caps and lost buttons, each one entered in a bark ledger as the forest's official lost-and-found. Henny took one look at the glittering pile, fluffed herself to twice her size, and settled down in the middle of it with the air of a queen claiming a throne.

"Those are not eggs," Flurry said, very carefully, from a safe distance.

Henny did not move. Henny tucked a particularly shiny cap a little further under her wing.

Jethro (the Mogollon Monster) tried diplomacy, which mostly meant looming nearby and smiling hopefully. Mabel (a wood elf) arrived, sighed the deep sigh of a woman who has seen this exact nonsense before, and fetched a tin pie plate of warm mash.

"Trade," Mabel announced. "One plate of mash for one log of bottle caps."

Henny considered. Henny ate the mash. Henny stayed exactly where she was.

The lost-and-found remains closed until further notice. Flurry has started a waiting list.

Printed with pride in Payson, in the shadow of the Rim · Set in hot metal by Dude, Bard of the Morning Scroll · May your Fredas be free of trolls, Clay.

